

Kenny Vo

Master of Architecture Candidate, Daniels Faculty, University of Toronto

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EDUCATION

Master of Architecture

Expected 2028

John H. Daniels Faculty of Architecture, Landscape, and Design, University of Toronto

Berlin, a City in Film. Daniels study abroad course, Berlin, Germany. July–August 2026.

Honours Bachelor of Arts, Architectural Studies (Technology Specialist)

2025

University of Toronto. Graduated with High Honours.

Undergraduate thesis: *To Hold and Let Go: Vietnamese Diasporic Memory in Domestic Spaces.* A study of how six Vietnamese-Canadian households in Southern Ontario negotiate cultural memory through the spatial and ritual organization of their homes.

X-Athenas: Architecture & Public Space Stories. Daniels study abroad course, Athens, Greece. May 2023.

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Paul Oberman Graduate Award, \$4,000. Travel and research funding for field research in southern Vietnam. 2026

John and Myrna Daniels Scholars, \$30,000 over three years. Renewable graduate award. 2025

Daniels Undergraduate Award, \$1,500 and \$1,000. 2024, 2023

CIE International Experience Award. Awarded for study abroad in Athens, Greece. 2023

President's Scholar of Excellence, University of Toronto, \$10,000. 2021

RESEARCH

Where the House Still Stands

Oct–Nov 2026

Domestic Space and Industrial Transformation on the Southwestern Edge of Ho Chi Minh City. Independent field research, Ho Chi Minh City and Hiệp Hòa, Vietnam, funded by the Paul Oberman Graduate Student Endowment Fund.

Twelve days of architectural fieldwork along a forty-kilometre line running from the tube-house wards of central Ho Chi Minh City to a cluster of family houses near the Vàm Cỏ Đông, studying how domestic form registers industrial land conversion and state administrative reorganization. Photography, measured drawing, and informal interview. Supplies basis for M.Arch thesis.

Learning with Machines: Sustainable AI-led Design

May–Jun 2025

Design Research Internship Program, Daniels Faculty, in partnership with BORTOLOTTTO.

Built a parametric pipeline in Grasshopper and Ladybug Tools generating roughly 1,500 sampled building variants through Latin hypercube sampling, then trained an XGBoost surrogate model with Bayesian hyperparameter tuning to return energy-use-intensity and useful-daylight predictions at design speed. Applied SHAP analysis to expose which variables drive performance, and multi-objective optimization to surface trade-offs. Produced a research document and a reusable Grasshopper toolset.

TEACHING

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Fall 2025

ARC180: Computation and Design / Technology Studio I. Daniels Faculty, under Paul Howard Harrison.

Led weekly tutorials for 43 students in foundational 3D modelling and computational design, held office hours, graded over 120 submissions, and built Rhino and Grasshopper demonstration workshops circulated to instructors across sections.

Instructor

Sep 2023 – Apr 2025

Applied Architecture, Landscape and Design (AALD), University of Toronto.

Designed and led workshops in Rhino and Grasshopper for the student organization, teaching computational design software to undergraduates outside the formal curriculum.

Digital Fabrication Lab Technologist

Apr 2024 – Apr 2025

Daniels Faculty, University of Toronto.

Trained students in the safe operation of ULS laser cutters, CNC and waterjet systems, and Ultimaker and Stratasys printers; serviced and assembled UR10e robotic systems and machined custom mounting rigs; assisted workshop facilitation at ROB|ARCH 2024, the international robotic fabrication conference hosted at the University of Toronto.

EXHIBITIONS AND INSTALLATIONS

Loom

June 2026

Varley Art Gallery of Markham, Markham, Ontario. With Cauri Ash, Bekkah Celikkanat, Sara De Sousa, and Anna Geng. Faculty: Humbi Song. Teaching assistant: Sadi Wali.

A woven pavilion making legible the physical infrastructure that sustains invisible digital processes. Wiring densities in the exterior panels correlate to the energy and water consumption of nearby data centres; visitor movement is tracked and translated into data, driving a pneumatic response in the inner walls. Arduino, computer vision, TouchDesigner.

Between, a Second Life

March 2026

Either/Or, Daniels Faculty, University of Toronto. Coordinator and exhibiting contributor.

Inaugural exhibition of the Either/Or collective, presenting creative work by Daniels students outside architectural coursework.

Robot Made 2025

Jul–Nov 2025

Galbraith Building forecourt, University of Toronto. Led by Nicholas Hoban (Daniels) and Aryan Rezaei Rad (Civil and Mineral Engineering), with fifteen student participants across Architecture and Engineering.

Full-scale reciprocal-frame timber pavilion of 110 bespoke elements, generated parametrically, fabricated on a seven-axis KUKA robot and CNC mill, and erected scaffold-free by hand without on-site measurement.

CURATORIAL AND EDITORIAL PRACTICE

Co-founder and Event Coordinator, Either/Or

Jan 2026 – present

Daniels Faculty, University of Toronto.

Student collective curating and exhibiting unconventional creative work by Daniels students and faculty.

Designer, Scaffold* Journal

Sep 2025 – present

Annual peer-reviewed design research journal produced by graduate and undergraduate students, Daniels Faculty.

Photography, editorial design, and promotion for Volume 3, determining how contributors' work is presented and circulated.

TECHNICAL AND FABRICATION

Taught: Rhino, Grasshopper, laser cutting, CNC and waterjet operation, 3D printing.

Computation: Rhino, Grasshopper, Ladybug and Honeybee, Rhino.Inside.Revit, KUKA PRC, Opossum, Python, C++; XGBoost, SHAP, Latin hypercube sampling, Bayesian optimization.

Fabrication: Six-axis KUKA and UR10e robotic systems, three-axis CNC, waterjet, ULS laser, Ultimaker and Stratasys printers.

Physical computing: Arduino, TouchDesigner, OpenCV computer vision, Metashape photogrammetry.

Representation: Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign; Revit, AutoCAD, Blender, V-Ray, D5; 35mm and digital photography.

SERVICE

Mentor, Daniels Faculty Mentorship Program. Four mentees over two years.

Oct 2023 – Apr 2025

Photographer, Architecture and Visual Studies Student Union.

Sep 2023 – Apr 2025

Information Technology Assistant, Daniels Faculty. Technical and plotter support.

Sep 2023 – Apr 2024

LANGUAGES

English (native). Vietnamese (conversational).